depicted in folk art in faraway Tamil Nadu as a decapitated head. The tribes of Nagaland practised headhunting into living memory. One wonders whether there is a link.

7. *China: A History*, John Keay. HarperCollins 2008.
8. *The Story of Asia's Lions*, Divyabhanusinh Chavda. Marg Publications, 2008.
9. This continued into much later times—Singapore was named after a lion whereas the animal in question was almost certainly a tiger.
10. The April 2010 census showed that Gir has 162 mature females, 97 mature males and 152 cubs. This is up from around 180 in the 1960s.
11. *The Story of Asia's Lions*, Divyabhanusinh Chavda. Marg Publications, 2008.
12. *The Penguin History of Early India*, Romila Thapar. Penguin, 2002
13. It is difficult to date this compendium but a version of this document probably existed by the third century BC. The text clearly states that surgery was a well-established science by the time the compendium was written. So, it is reasonable to say that this body of knowledge was systematized in the late Iron Age. However, it appears to have been repeatedly edited in later centuries. The current version of the text may be as late as the fifth century AD.
14. *The Roots of Ayurveda*, Dominik Wijastyk. Penguin, 2001.
15. *The Invasion of India by Alexander the Great as described by Arrian, Q. Curtius, Diodorus, Plutarch and Justin*. J.W. McCrindle, Archibald Constable & Co., 1896. Reprinted 1984 by Eastern Book House.
16. *The Invasion of India by Alexander the Great as described by Arrian, Q. Curtius, Diodorus, Plutarch and Justin*. J.W. McCrindle, Archibald Constable & Co., 1896. Reprinted 1984 by Eastern Book House.
17. Some scholars argue that Kautilya and Chanakya were different people but I have stuck to the traditional view here.
18. *The Invasion of India by Alexander the Great as described by Arrian, Q. Curtius, Diodorus, Plutarch and Justin*. J.W. McCrindle, Archibald Constable & Co., 1896. Reprinted 1984 by Eastern Book House.
19. There is another tradition that he remained a minister into Bindusara's reign.
20. *The Story of India*, Michael Wood. BBC Worldwide, 2008.
21. Presumably from wounds and famine.
22. Dhamma (Dharma) is an important concept in both Hinduism and Buddhism. It is difficult to translate but broadly relates to the duty to do the right thing.
23. *The Penguin History of Early India*, Romila Thapar. Penguin, 2002.
24. The empire was larger than modern-day India and its overall population would have been around 75–80 million. These are my own guesstimates.
25. *From Stone Quarry to Sculpturing Workshop: A Report on the Archaeological Investigations around Chunar, Varanasi and Sarnath*, Vidula Jayaswal, Agam Kala Prakashan, 1998.
26. *The Story of Asia's Lions*, Divyabhanusinh Chavda. Marg Publications, 2008; *The True Chronology of Ashokan Pillars*, John Irwin, *Artibus Asiae*, XLIV, IFA, NYU, 1983.
27. Note that Megasthenes's *Indika* has been lost but sections have been preserved in other Greek writings.
28. *The Penguin History of Early India*, Romila Thapar. Penguin, 2002; ASI (http://asi.nic.in/asi_exca_imp_bihar.asp)
29. *The Arthashastra*, Kautilya, (trans.) L.N. Rangarajan, Penguin, 1987.